



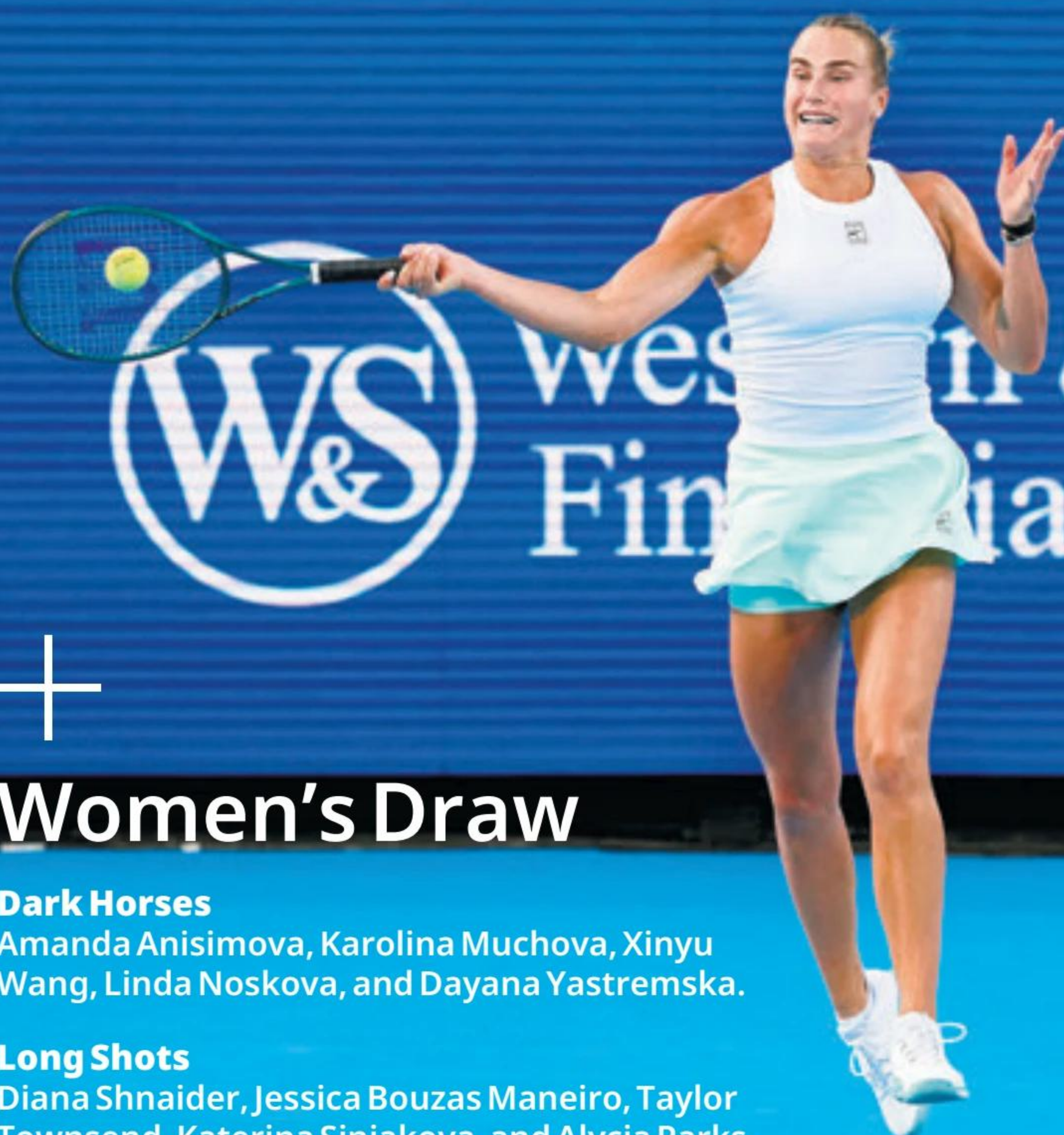
Women's Draw

Dark Horses

Amanda Anisimova, Karolina Muchova, Xinyu Wang, Linda Noskova, and Dayana Yastremska.

Long Shots

Diana Shnaider, Jessica Bouzas Maneiro, Taylor Townsend, Katerina Siniakova, and Alycia Parks.



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A worrying trend: World No. 1 and defending champion Aryna Sabalenka, despite her many strengths, has developed a habit of losing matches she should win.

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No. 5, brings notes to the court and gets instructions from Martinez during matches. However, she occasionally lapses into teenage moodiness and passive play when the going gets tough. Andreeva (**left**) will doubtless win Majors, but a quarterfinal showing is more likely this fortnight.

Iga Swiatek — Swiatek became the first Polish player to win the Wimbledon title during the Open Era and the third woman in the Open Era to win all of their first six Grand Slam singles finals, after Margaret Court and Monica Seles. Although she never faced a top-10 opponent at the Big W, she dropped only 19 games in her last five matches, overwhelming 2021 Olympic gold medallist Belinda

Bencic 6-2, 6-0 in the semis and surprise finalist Anisimova 6-0, 6-0.

Her resume includes the 2022 US Open title, but she has often been beaten on hard courts by heavy hitters such as Sabalenka (three times), Keys (twice), Rybakina (twice), Tauson, Collins, and Linda Noskova.

With the 24-year-old's brilliant career back on track, this intense perfectionist can relax a bit and resume winning Majors. Though that is unlikely to happen in New York, where she will advance to the semis or possibly the final, depending on her draw.

Aryna Sabalenka — How can the No. 1 player in the world, with a huge 4,341-point lead over No. 2 Gauff (as of August 11) and the holder of three hard-court Grand Slam titles, not be a solid favourite to win her fourth at the U.S. Open? The short answer is that Sabalenka, despite her many assets — most notably, her flawless technique, potent shots, and increasingly versatile game — has a habit of losing matches she should